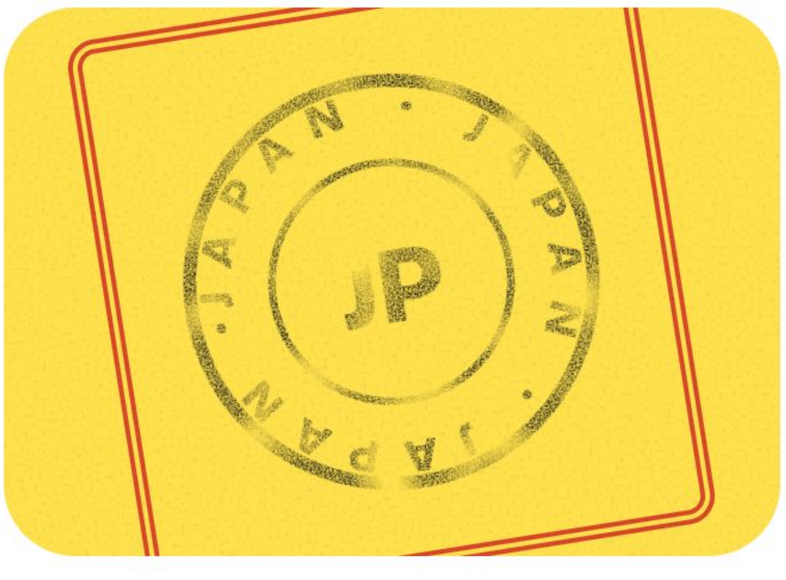
A startup city guide to Japan

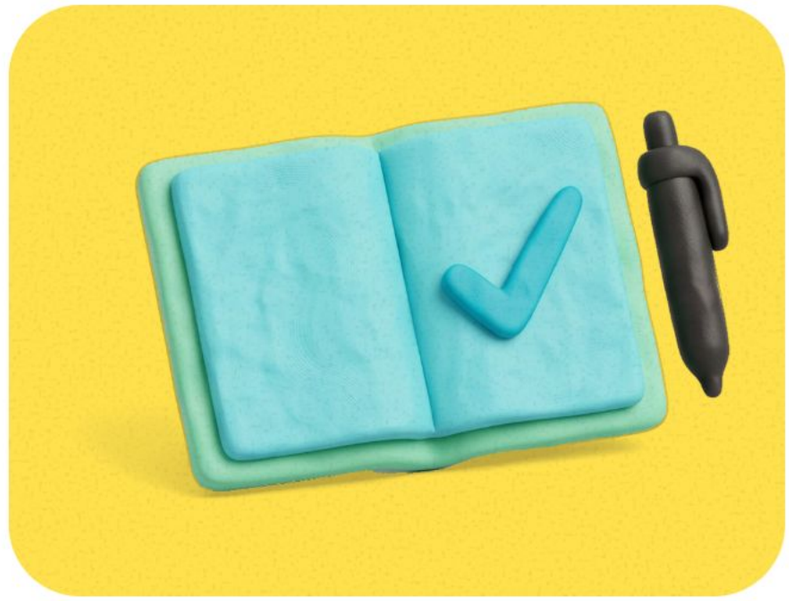




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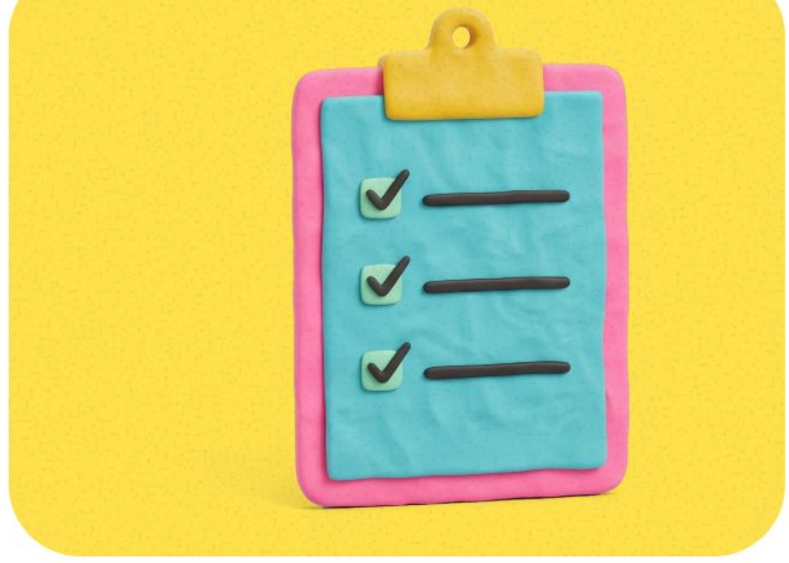
Five cities, five strengths



City	Best for	Start here
Tokyo	Investors, HQ clients	Shibuya startup support
Fukuoka	Lower costs, Asia access	Fukuoka Growth Next
Nagoya	Manufacturing, mobility	STATION Ai
Osaka · Kyoto	Life sciences, hardware	University networks
Sendai	Deep tech	Tohoku University

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Numbers to know



10th

Tokyo's global rank in Startup Genome's 2024 report

500

Startups based at Nagoya's STATION Ai, opened 2024

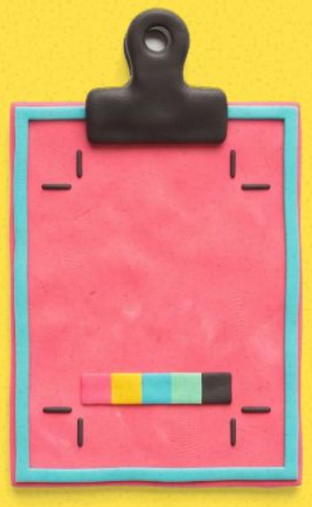
¥30m

Business Manager visa capital since October 2025

Source: Startup Genome GSER 2024 · STATION Ai · 出入...

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The visa route now



Startup visa

City-backed time to prepare

Business Manager

¥30m capital, staff, Japanese ability

Good news

Startup visa time counts as experience

Source: 出入国在留管理庁 Immigration Services Agency

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Pick customers, then city

Choose where your buyers and partners are first.

Then use that city's support desk. Most will help with visas, offices and introductions.

Customers

↓

City

↓

Support desk



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Japan's best startup city depends on who you sell to.

Taking a Western brand into Japan, Korea or wider APAC?

Give me a shout

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